

GPU price drops expected

NVIDIA is expected to drop prices of their GeForce line of cards soon after AMD launched the Radeon HD6000 series

perhaps in another you will find that the same photo frame is being sold at something like ₹1,800, or basically at a much lower price. So, if another shop has the same TV on offer for ₹2,000 cheaper, without any freebies, you're actually getting a better deal.

Another way to look at our example is to look at the photo frame as product you want to purchase. Would you spend that money (₹6,000 in our example) on a photo frame? If not, don't even consider the offer. If you're not the shy type, do what I do and say, "I don't want the photo frame. I'll pay you ₹3,000 less and take the TV and you sell the photo frame for ₹6,000 and



Be sure of the kind of wall mount being provided

make an even bigger profit." This is when I usually get the customary dirty-look or wry smile from the salesman, and that's the end of that. Of course, I have to admit that sometimes these deals do add up quite nicely, so don't think they're always bad...just as you shouldn't think that they're always good deals, either...

The next type of pull is the lucky



Home Theater Systems given away with TVs are useful, as TVs have poor speakers



A free Blu-ray player with a LCD or Plasma TV makes good sense

draw. Don't get swayed by the shiny new car, bike or whatever's on display as the lucky prize. If you're really feeling lucky, buy a lottery ticket for a several crore bumper draw. You have about the same chances of winning either of them.

Also, don't forget to check out the smaller retailers. It's not a hard and fast rule or anything like that, but I've found that a lot of smaller retailers are generally more interested in making a sale, and will give you freebies that you can actually use, or want. They are also more open to bargaining, which means you're paying closer to the real price. After



Free portable data cards are handy, but monthly charges might be high

all, they spend less on rent, electricity and advertising, and thus can actually afford to have smaller profit margins.

Now, let's take a look at some of the hottest categories individually and I'll walk you through what I found.

Digital cameras

Do your own research, because almost all of the sales people I met just do not know what they're talking about. They

just try and sway your decision based on what's not selling, or what they will get higher commissions for. Make up your mind about what camera you want, and then look for comparisons online or in magazines like Digit.

With cameras especially, look for freebies like memory cards, carry pouches or sleeves. You can also get these at smaller dealers, but you might have to ask for them.

Exchange offers

Some of the offers in the market today might have something to do with exchanging older products and getting new ones in their place. Of course, you'll have to pay a big chunk of the new product's price. There's a possibility that you will end up spending more or less the same amount as the new product. Look for at least a 20 per cent reduction in the retail price before opting for an exchange. If not, you'll most likely be giving away your old product for free and getting the new product for the usual MOP you'd pay anyway.

Of course this sometimes only applies to the more popular price ranges. It's not uncommon to find that festive season or not, you'll get no freebies with dSLRs.

As for memory cards, with a 4 GB SD memory card available for a mere ₹800, don't even try and feign interest in any offer less than an 8GB memory card. This is for cameras that are in the price range of ₹7,000 to ₹10,000. For more expensive cameras, there better be much more than just a memory card in the bundle.

Cameras are an oddity, because I've found that the smaller shops actually have many more models for sale than you'll find at a large mall.

You might also come across offers of a bundled watch, and other point-less accessories. Don't fall for those; the watches are almost always cheap, and don't even last very long.

Phones

Mobile phones are another active category of products. Some of us switch phones every year, or even more often.